

MICHAEL MWALIMU KASIKE

Full-Stack Software Engineer | Java Spring Boot | React | Microservices

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Location: Kitui, Eastern Kenya | Open to Remote & Relocation

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Full-Stack Software Engineer specializing in Java, Spring Boot, React, and scalable distributed applications. Experienced in designing and developing full-stack systems using microservice architecture, REST APIs, WebSockets, Redis caching, gRPC, Apache Kafka, PostgreSQL, and Spring Security. Strong focus on application performance, responsiveness, clean architecture, maintainability, and solving complex engineering problems. Built personal projects that demonstrate practical experience in real-time communication, asynchronous event-driven systems, service-to-service communication, caching, and responsive React interfaces.

CORE TECHNICAL SKILLS

Backend & Microservices

- Java (Java 8+), Spring Boot, Spring Data JPA, Hibernate
- Spring Security, JWT authentication, role-based access control

- RESTful API design, microservice architecture, service integration
- gRPC for inter-service communication
- Apache Kafka for event-driven and asynchronous communication
- WebSockets for real-time application features

Frontend

- JavaScript (ES6+), React.js
- HTML5, CSS3, Bootstrap, Tailwind CSS
- Responsive UI, component-based development, API integration

Databases, Caching & Infrastructure

- PostgreSQL, MySQL
- Redis caching
- Docker, Git, GitHub, CI/CD fundamentals
- Cloud-ready application design (AWS/GCP concepts)

Engineering Practices

- Clean Architecture, SOLID principles, performance optimization
- Debugging, bottleneck identification, secure application development
- Technical documentation, system analysis, problem solving

KEY PROJECTS

Ride-Hailing / Ride Management Application

Technologies: Java, Spring Boot, Spring Security, React, PostgreSQL, Redis, WebSockets, gRPC, Apache Kafka, Docker

- Designed and developed a full-stack ride-hailing platform using Spring Boot microservices and a React frontend.
- Implemented real-time communication with WebSockets for ride requests, driver availability, ride status updates, and live application events.
- Used Redis for caching frequently accessed data and supporting low-latency application behavior.
- Implemented Apache Kafka for asynchronous, event-driven communication between microservices.
- Used gRPC for efficient service-to-service communication within the distributed backend.
- Built REST APIs and secured application access using Spring Security and JWT-based authentication.
- Implemented ride requests, nearby-driver matching, vehicle type selection, vehicle information, and ride-charge functionality.
- Developed a responsive React frontend integrated with backend services.

Patient Management System

Technologies: Java, Spring Boot, Spring Security, React, PostgreSQL, Redis, WebSockets, gRPC, Apache Kafka, Docker

- Designed and developed a full-stack patient management platform using Spring Boot microservices and a React frontend.
- Implemented service-to-service communication using gRPC and asynchronous event processing using Apache Kafka.
- Used Redis caching to improve performance for frequently accessed application data.
- Implemented WebSockets for real-time updates and communication between backend services and the frontend.
- Built secure REST APIs with Spring Security and JWT authentication.
- Designed persistence layers using Spring Data JPA, Hibernate, and PostgreSQL.
- Applied microservice and clean architecture principles to improve scalability, maintainability, and separation of responsibilities.

University Management System

Technologies: Java, Spring Boot, Spring Data JPA, Hibernate, PostgreSQL, Spring Security, React

- Designed and implemented a full-stack university management system covering students, lecturers, courses, departments, results, and administration.
- Built secure REST APIs with role-based access for Admin, Lecturer, and Student users.
- Implemented data persistence using Hibernate and Spring Data JPA.

- Developed a responsive React frontend integrated with the Spring Boot backend.
- Applied clean architecture principles for scalability and maintainability.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Freelance Enterprise Java / Full-Stack Developer

2024 – Present

- Designed and developed full-stack applications using Spring Boot backends and React frontends.
- Built secure APIs using Spring Security and JWT authentication.
- Implemented ORM-based persistence layers with Hibernate and JPA.
- Worked with distributed-system concepts including microservices, asynchronous messaging, caching, and real-time communication.
- Focused on application performance, scalability, maintainability, and clean code practices.

IT Department – Machakos County Headquarters (Industrial Attachment)

2020

- Supported enterprise IT systems, troubleshooting, maintenance, data management, and system operations.
- Collaborated with IT teams in a real-world enterprise environment.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science – Mathematics & Computer Science

Maseno University | 2017 – 2021 | Second Class Upper Division

STRENGTHS

- Full-stack development and system design
- Microservice and backend architecture
- Real-time and event-driven systems
- Performance optimization and caching
- Strong problem-solving and analytical skills
- Secure application development
- Technical communication and continuous learning